



India's home series wins since defeat to England in 2012

Opponent	Year	Margin of victory
Australia	2012/13	4-0
West Indies	2013/14	2-0
South Africa	2015/16	3-0
New Zealand	2016/17	3-0
England	2016/17	4-0
Bangladesh	2016/17	1-0 (one-off Test)
Australia	2016/17	2-1
Sri Lanka	2017/18	1-0
Afghanistan	2018	1-0 (one-off Test)
West Indies	2018/19	2-0
South Africa	2019/20	3-0
Bangladesh	2019/20	2-0
England	2020/21	3-1
New Zealand	2021/22	1-0
Sri Lanka	2021/22	2-0
Australia	2022/23	2-1
England	2023/24	4-1
Bangladesh	2024/25	2-0

to tally more than 200 runs in the series.

The left-handed duo succeeded, to some extent, in taking the attack to the opposition's spinners, with Pant almost pulling off a counter-attacking rescue act in Mumbai.

Though Shubman Gill, after missing the series opener, shone in patches and struck a resilient 90 in the third Test to help India draw parity in the first innings, his tentative front-foot defence against spin was an enduring trope that haunted India's top and middle-order batters.

Pitch-ing it wrong

As New Zealand's spinners dominated on rank turners in Pune and Mumbai, questions have emerged about whether India needs to reconsider its pitch

Flamboyant southpaw: Rishabh Pant's ongoing excellence and calmness under pressure also offered a bright spot in an otherwise challenging series. K. MURALI KUMAR

strategy at home. The answer could well be "yes."

Departing from its previous approach of preparing sporting surfaces — as seen during the series against England — the current team management, under head coach Gautam Gambhir, reverted to rank turners, banking on spinners Ravichandran Ashwin and Ravindra Jadeja to deliver. However, the strategy backfired in both matches as India's spinners fell short of expectations, losing the advantage on home turf. Assistant coach Abhishek Nayar defended the approach, noting that the team